

LinkedIn Free Search Guide

Finding Business Owners, CEOs & CFOs — No Premium Required

Identify decision-makers in any city using only LinkedIn's free search. Step-by-step system, Boolean search formulas, power search templates, and a daily routine to build your pipeline — all without a paid subscription.

OBJECTIVE

Find Decision-Makers in Any City

Identify CEOs, CFOs, and Business Owners in any market using only LinkedIn's free search. No Sales Navigator. No paid tools. Just the right search formula executed consistently.

1

START WITH THE SEARCH BAR

Type your target title + city directly into LinkedIn's main search bar. Keep it simple and specific.

2

CLICK "PEOPLE" TO FILTER RESULTS

After searching, click the "People" tab at the top of results. This filters out companies, jobs, and posts — showing only profiles.

3

ADD LOCATION FILTER

Use the "Locations" filter to narrow to your target city or metro area. This dramatically improves result quality.

4

REFINE BY TITLE

Use the "Title" filter to target: **CEO, CFO, Owner, Founder, President, Managing Partner, Principal**

POWER SEARCH FORMULA

The 3-Part Formula

[TITLE] + [CITY] + [INDUSTRY]

– The most reliable formula for finding qualified prospects

Examples

CEO San Diego healthcare
CFO Dallas construction
"business owner" Phoenix restaurants
Founder Miami tech

Title by Company Size

Small Business → Owner / Founder
Mid-Size → CEO / President
Financial Talks → CFO
Add industry for precision

ADVANCED SEARCH LOGIC

Boolean Search: Your Precision Tool

Boolean operators let you expand, narrow, or exclude results with surgical precision. Master these four operators and your search quality multiplies immediately.

OR

Expand results — finds profiles matching either term

```
CEO OR CFO Miami
"business owner" OR owner OR founder
Dallas
```

AND

Narrow results — both terms must appear

```
CEO AND manufacturing Chicago
CFO AND healthcare Phoenix
```

NOT

Exclude results — removes unwanted matches

```
owner NOT realtor NOT recruiter
Tampa
CEO NOT nonprofit Austin
```

" "

Exact phrase — forces exact match

```
"business owner" Chicago
"managing partner" Dallas finance
```

◆ PRO TIP — COMBINE OPERATORS FOR MAXIMUM PRECISION

Stack operators together: `(CEO OR CFO OR Owner) AND healthcare NOT recruiter Dallas` — This single search finds all three title types in healthcare in Dallas while filtering out recruiters.

PRO TIPS BY ROLE

Target the Right Title

OWNER / FOUNDER

Best for small businesses with 1–50 employees. They control all financial decisions and respond fastest to cost-saving conversations.

CEO / PRESIDENT

Best for mid-size companies (50–500 employees). Strategic thinkers. Lead with ROI and competitive advantage, not just savings.

CFO

Best for financial conversations — R&D credits, tax optimization, payroll cost reduction. They speak numbers. Bring numbers.

ADD INDUSTRY

Always add an industry keyword to your search. It dramatically reduces noise and surfaces prospects who are more likely to qualify for

YOUR DAILY SYSTEM

Consistency Builds Pipeline. Pipeline Builds Business.

1

Run 2–3
Searches

2

Open 10–20
Profiles

3

Save Top
Prospects

4

Send
Connections

∞

Repeat
Daily

LEAD TRACKER TEMPLATE

NAME	TITLE	COMPANY	CITY	STATUS
—	CEO	—	—	Connected
—	CFO	—	—	Pending
—	Owner	—	—	Messaged

◆ KEY STRATEGY

Focus on specific roles, industries, and cities. Find the right **10 people per day** — not 100 random ones. Quality targeting beats volume every time.

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